

Presentation Studio

Source Installation Guide

Set up the Electron desktop app, connect any standard MCP client, and understand the project and export security boundaries.

INSTALLATION	PROJECTS	AI CONTROL
Source setup only macOS and Windows	Self-contained optional encryption	Local MCP human review gates

Important

There is no DMG, PKG, MSI, EXE, app-store package, or other application installer in this release. The setup scripts install and verify the source checkout without disabling operating-system protections.

Before you begin

Presentation Studio is designed for local presentation review. Imported PowerPoint files are copied into a self-contained project, audited without changing the originals, and exported only as new files after a human approves a cleanup plan.

Requirements

Operating system	macOS or Windows
Runtime	Node.js 22.13 or newer with npm
Disk space	Enough local space for source decks, packaged Resources, recovery files, and exported copies
Network	Needed only to obtain source dependencies when they are not already cached; the running app blocks non-local network requests

What setup verifies

The setup scripts run the locked dependency install, automated tests, repository data-safety scan, and production renderer build. A successful setup proves the current checkout can run; it does not approve any presentation for distribution.

Data boundary	Do not place client decks, manuscripts, project packages, extracted text, previews, or exports in the repository. Synthetic fixtures are generated locally and ignored by Git.
----------------------	--

Install on macOS

Use the included source setup script. It checks the installed Node.js version and stops with a clear message if the requirement is not met.

- 1 Download or clone the Presentation Studio repository to a local folder.
- 2 Double-click **scripts/setup-macos.command**, or run it from Terminal.
- 3 Wait for dependency installation, tests, data-safety checks, and the production build to pass.
- 4 Start the app with **scripts/start-macos.command**.

Terminal commands

```
./scripts/setup-macos.command  
./scripts/start-macos.command
```

macOS security

The script does not change Gatekeeper, quarantine attributes, or other operating-system protections. Follow your organization's approved software process if local policy blocks source execution.

Install on Windows

- 1 Download or clone the repository and open PowerShell in that folder.
- 2 Run the setup script shown below. It performs the same checks as macOS.
- 3 Start the app with the separate start script after setup passes.

```
& .\scripts\setup-windows.ps1  
& .\scripts\start-windows.ps1
```

Windows security

The script does not change PowerShell execution policy, SmartScreen, or other protections. Use an approved policy exception or source-install process instead of disabling controls.

Connect an MCP client

Presentation Studio exposes a standard STDIO MCP server. It can be used by any compatible AI client; the app does not contain a provider-specific model or API-key workflow.

- 1

Open Presentation Studio and keep the desktop app running.
- 2

Print the standard configuration snippet with the command below.
- 3

Add the **presentation-studio** entry to your MCP client's normal **mcpServers** configuration, then restart that client if required.
- 4

Turn on the visible **AI session** switch in Presentation Studio only when you want the current audit metadata available.

```
node scripts/configure-mcp.mjs
```

To merge the entry into an explicitly selected JSON file:

```
node scripts/configure-mcp.mjs --write /absolute/path/to/mcp-config.json
```

MCP safety model

Allowed	Human only
Check app status List authorized deck metadata Read deterministic audit findings Stage a bounded cleanup proposal	Confirm a template Apply or reject a proposal Save a project Export a PowerPoint copy Distribute an output

Local connection

The STDIO server reaches the active app through a per-session token on a loopback-only bridge. The token descriptor is written with private local permissions and removed when the app closes.

Projects, encryption, and verification

Project formats

.pstudio	.pstudio-secure
ZIP-based self-contained package Canonical project JSON Immutable-by-hash Resources Portable without original file paths	Encrypts the complete .pstudio payload AES-256-GCM PBKDF2-SHA-256 with 250,000 iterations Password cannot be recovered

Encryption boundary

Encrypted project files protect packaged JSON and Resources. They do not encrypt the external originals or separately exported PowerPoint, PDF, SVG, or PNG files.

Verify the checkout

```
npm test
npm run check:data-safety
npm run build
npm run desktop:smoke
```

Expected result

Tests should pass, the repository scan should report no tracked client artifacts, Vite should produce a production bundle, and the Electron smoke check should save a valid renderer capture before exiting.

Troubleshooting

App reports that setup is missing

Run the platform setup script from the repository root so that node_modules and the production bundle are created.

MCP says the app is unavailable

Open Presentation Studio first. Restart the desktop app if the local runtime descriptor is stale, then retry the MCP tool.

A deck needs manual review

Macros, embedded OLE objects, external relationships, uncertain templates, and ambiguous formatting intentionally stop automated cleanup. Preserve the source and resolve the finding in the app.